Yahya Alsharif

Software Engineering Student | AI and Software Development
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineering student at Umm Al-Qura University (GPA 3.89/4.00) and a KAUST Academy AI intern, selected among the top 100 students from more than 14,000 applicants. Works across the applied AI pipeline, from dataset and label design to quantised deployment on edge hardware, with third-place finishes in two KAUST Academy machine learning competitions. Coordinates a six-person graduation project and owns its documentation and repository.

EXPERIENCE

KAUST Academy, AI Intern King Khalid University, Abha | Jun 2026 to Aug 2026

- Model-side developer on an eight-week AI Specialisation internship, owning dataset selection, label design, training, evaluation, optimisation and deployment packaging for the team's privacy model.
- Trained daily through lectures, hands-on labs and project work across three tracks: computer vision and generative models, reinforcement learning, and NLP with transformers, LLM fine-tuning, speech, agents and RAG.
- Applied the inference optimisation and Edge AI material to a team project mentored by KAUST faculty and researchers.

KAUST Academy, Kaggle Competitor Jul 2026 to Aug 2026

- Competed in KAUST Academy Kaggle challenges across image classification, generation, inpainting, segmentation, natural language and audio.
- **Cell instance segmentation, third of 24 teams.** Segmented neuronal cells in fluorescence microscopy with a ConvNeXt-Tiny U-Net regressing a normalised distance map, decoded by marker-controlled watershed: 0.8144 instance F1 on a near-duplicate-aware grouped split and 0.5472 private instance F1, above the previous year's winner.
- **Image inpainting, third place.** Built an end-to-end MI-GAN pipeline with YuNet face filtering and test-matched dynamic masking, reconstructing all 8,000 test images for a private-leaderboard FID of 12.02.

PROJECTS

OnKith, Privacy-Aware Edge AI | Team Project, KAUST Academy Jun 2026 to Aug 2026

- Moved the privacy component from binary classification to token-level PII masking, built a BiLSTM tagger baseline, then prepared aligned BIO spans over 147,366 English rows of OpenPII 1.5M and fine-tuned TinyBERT (4L-312D) to 0.973 token-level micro-F1 and 0.957 entity-level F1 on a 40,908-row held-out split.
- Traced its weaknesses to dataset imbalance, rare-label failure and weak generalisation, redesigned the Model V2 data and evaluation strategy around a maintained 31-entity privacy ontology, and retrained on DeBERTa-v3-xsmall: out-of-distribution typed F1 rose from 0.46 to 0.62, private-character recall from 0.32 to 0.84.
- Exported FP32 and INT8 ONNX artefacts, cutting the first deployed model from 54.5 MB to 13.7 MB for 0.3 points of token F1; diagnosed an apparent INT8 collapse as a SentencePiece token-grouping defect in the production decoder, fixed it under regression tests, and benchmarked the final system on Raspberry Pi 5 at 0.945 typed F1 and 53 ms median latency.

ESAS, Experience Saudi As a Saudi | Graduation Project, Umm Al-Qura University Aug 2025 to Aug 2026

- Coordinated a six-person team from brainstorming through planning and requirements gathering, turning an initial concept into a structured engineering project.
- Owned the repository and the documentation set: Software Requirements Specification, system workflows, use cases and diagrams, project reports and the exhibition poster, reviewing contributions before merge.
- Implemented backend and frontend features for catalogue browsing, role-based access, booking and the provider and administrator dashboards; presented the poster and live demo at INJAZ 2026.

EDUCATION

Umm Al-Qura University, BSc Software Engineering Aug 2023 to Jun 2027 (expected)
Makkah, Saudi Arabia *GPA: 3.89/4.00*

- **Relevant coursework:** requirements engineering, software testing, system analysis, algorithms and data structures.

KAUST Academy, Artificial Intelligence Specialisation Nov 2025 to Jun 2026

- Selected among the top 100 students from more than 14,000 applicants; passed every stage of the specialisation, through the introductory and advanced artificial intelligence levels, to qualify for the 2026 Summer Internship.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software Engineering: object-oriented programming, requirements engineering, SRS, system design, software architecture, testing, technical documentation, project coordination.
Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, HTML, CSS.
AI and Machine Learning: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, ONNX Runtime, TensorFlow Lite, OpenCV, Gymnasium, NumPy, deep learning, computer vision, generative models, NLP, large language models, reinforcement learning, INT8 quantisation, Edge AI.
Frontend and Tools: React, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Git, GitHub, GitHub Pages, Docker, VS Code.

CERTIFICATIONS AND LANGUAGES

Certifications: Advanced Artificial Intelligence (KAUST Academy) • Fundamentals of Deep Learning (NVIDIA) • Convolutional Neural Networks, and Linear Algebra for ML and Data Science (DeepLearning.AI) • Introduction to Data Science in Python (Univ. of Michigan).
Languages: Arabic, native. • English, professional proficiency (IELTS Academic 8.0, CEFR C1).